

The Road to the American Revolution

Follow the chain of taxes, protests, and reactions from 1763 to 1775 and decide which link did the most to turn disagreement into war.

? Historical challenge

The American Revolution did not begin with a single event. Between 1763 and 1775, a chain of British taxes and colonial protests — each answered by a sharper reaction — pushed the colonies toward war. Trace the chain from pressure to consequence, and decide which link mattered most.

1 Investigate

SOURCES 1

Roots of Rebellion – National Archives Museum

PRIMARY SOURCE

Documents from the years of rising tension before the war.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- What did the Proclamation of 1763 do?
- Why would that anger colonists?

SOURCES 2

April 19, 1775 – Minute Man National Historical Park (NPS)

SECONDARY SOURCE

The first battles at Lexington Green and Concord's North Bridge.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- Why did British troops march to Concord?
- How did the fighting spread?

SOURCES 3

'No Taxation Without Representation' – Library of Congress

SECONDARY SOURCE

How colonists argued that taxes required their consent through their own representatives.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- What did 'no taxation without representation' mean?
- How did colonists act on that idea?

2 Build your Event Map

Fill in the organizer from the evidence. Mark information with ①②③ to show which source it came from. Leave a space blank if the sources don't tell you.

PRESSURE



ACTION



REACTION



ESCALATION



EVENT



CONSEQUENCES

Where might events have gone differently?

People / groups responsible

Sons of Liberty — organized protest and boycotts

Samuel Adams — Boston organizer and agitator

King George III and Parliament — issued the taxes and the Coercive Acts

Colonial militia (Minutemen) —

Which link was most important?

	fought at Lexington and Concord	
Sources 1	Sources 2	Sources 3

3 Compare

- Compare your chains with a partner. Did you order the links the same way?
- Did you choose the same 'most important link'? Defend your choice with evidence.

4 Expand

Your teacher will add context, vocabulary, and information the sources leave out. Add it to your map.

5 Revise

Go back to your Event Map. Add, correct, or reorganize based on the discussion.

6 Conclude

Which link in the chain did the most to make war unavoidable? Support your claim with evidence from at least two sources and two links.